

LET ME TRY · FREE PRINTABLE

Dressing Alone: Step-by-Step Cards

Self-care · Ages 2½–4

Dressing is a long sequence of small skills. Teach one at a time, on calm days, and expect inside-out shirts for a while. That's progress.

The jacket flip

- ○ Lay the jacket on the floor, open, inside facing up.
- ○ Child stands at the hood end, toes near the hood.
- ○ Crouch, put both arms into the sleeves.
- ○ Lift and flip it over the head. Arms slide in.

Pants and socks

- ○ Sit on the floor or a low stool.
- ○ One leg in, then the other. Stand up, pull up.
- ○ Socks: roll them first, then pull over the toes.

T-shirt

- ○ Lay it face down, tag at the top, near the child.
- ○ Arms in first, then the head.
- ○ Or head first, then arms. Let them choose what works.

Set up for success

- ○ Easy clothes: elastic waists, big buttons, velcro shoes
- ○ A low hook or drawer they can reach
- ○ A small mirror at their height
- ○ Two outfit choices laid out the night before

Timing

Start on weekends or holidays. Add 10 minutes to school mornings once they're confident.

SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

Montessori, M. The Discovery of the Child (care of the self).

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